Sergey Istomin

Senior Python Developer / Tech Lead

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SUMMARY

Senior Python Developer and Tech Lead, 10+ years in backend, microservices and high-load systems. Strong in Python / Django / FastAPI, cloud (AWS, Azure) and LLM / RAG / ML infrastructure; led distributed teams and shipped production solutions.

SKILLS

Core	Python, asyncio, REST, Pytest, unit & integration testing
Web / API	Django, FastAPI, Flask, Django REST Framework
Data & messaging	PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, ClickHouse, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Celery
DevOps & Cloud	Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI/CD, Linux, Git, AWS, Azure, Terraform
ML / LLM	LLM, RAG, LangChain, LlamaIndex, PyTorch, Transformers
Languages	English (Upper-Intermediate), Russian (Native)

EXPERIENCE

Raiffeisen — Senior Python Developer / ML Engineer — Mar 2024 – Jun 2026

- Took a part in the development of an internal corporate portal. Django, PostgreSQL, Celery, Kubernetes
- Built an LLM-based chatbot using a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) architecture. Python, LangChain, LlamaIndex, Transformers, PgVector
- Designed and implemented a CI/CD pipeline automating build, deployment and integration for the chatbot. GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes
- Created backend services powering chatbot functionality and performance. FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Redis
- Developed a module for registering and managing network equipment: inventory, onboarding, config storage, automated device interaction over the network, and centralized management via a REST API. Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, SNMP, SSH
- Built a framework for benchmarking LLM inference speed. PyTorch, Transformers

Positive Technologies — Senior Python Developer — Feb 2023 – Apr 2024

- Participated in the Network Attack Discovery (NAD) service. Django, Celery, PostgreSQL, ElasticSearch
- Refactored legacy synchronous modules to asyncio, significantly improving throughput; implemented sync/async interop via message queues and integrated process-based scanning tools into the pipeline. Python, asyncio, multiprocessing
- Set up logging and metrics delivery (Carbon/Graphite/Grafana); reworked the OAuth-based auth system.

Quantum Soft — Senior Python Developer — Jul 2021 – Sep 2022

- Project for Korn Ferry — an ML-based recommendation system for candidate evaluation.
- Built services exposing ML models via API on Microsoft Azure; owned cloud integrations and infrastructure-as-code. Azure, Service Bus, Event Grid, Terraform, FastAPI, asyncio, pydantic

EPAM Systems — Senior Python Developer — Apr 2019 – Jul 2021

- Audigent (adtech): ML models and web scraping for web-page topic classification. Python, AWS, Scrapy
- Merck (pharma): data collection and preparation for ML pipelines on AWS Lambda. Python, Go, Docker
- Scenario-based load-testing infrastructure for a European content provider. Python, asyncio, Docker, Nomad, RabbitMQ

Bars Group — Senior Python Developer / Team Lead — Jan 2016 – Mar 2019

- Led development of web systems for cloud accounting and HR management for public-sector organizations across multiple regions.
- Managed a distributed team; established Agile practices, planning and code review. Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Dali** — on-prem RCA diagnostics for industry: structured root-cause reports over RAG, data stays in the customer's network; assembly-line pilot. FastAPI, LiteLLM, PostgreSQL/pgvector
- **Rubezh** — self-hostable LLM guardrail (RU/technical): blocks prompt injection and jailbreaks without flagging legitimate safety-manual terms. Python, FastAPI, LiteLLM
- **Open source** — Supportal (web-chat to Telegram relay), MCP servers (QEMU, unix-pass), a workstation CVE scanner.

EDUCATION

Master's degree — Computer Science and Management in Technical Systems — 2016
St. Petersburg State University of Aerospace Instrumentation

Bachelor's degree (not finished) — Computer Science and Management in Technical Systems — 2002
Peter the Great St. Petersburg Polytechnic University